

Early-Stage Founder Fundamentals Checklist

The fundamentals that are easy to get wrong early, and expensive to fix later — built from actually building a business, not just advising on one.

1. Pricing

- ☐ Does your pricing actually cover your real costs, not just the obvious ones?
- ☐ Have you tested a price change, or just guessed and left it?
- ☐ Do you know your margin on your best-seller versus your most-promoted item?

2. Product & range

- ☐ Has your product or menu range grown organically, with nobody testing what actually sells?
- ☐ Do you know your top 3 performers, and are you promoting them enough?
- ☐ Is there anything on your range purely out of habit, not performance?

3. Stock & operations

- ☐ Are you managing stock by feel, or by an actual system?
- ☐ Do you regularly overorder, or run out, of the same things?
- ☐ Would someone else be able to run your ordering process without you?

4. Brand consistency

- ☐ Does your brand look and feel the same across social, packaging, and in person?
- ☐ Is there one person who owns that consistency, or does it drift?
- ☐ Would a new customer recognise you across two different channels?

How to read your answers: almost every early-stage business hits some version of these — it's completely normal. What matters is catching it early, while it's still cheap to fix.

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Built Pako Taco from concept to award-winning, handling every one of these myself.

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